Section B
Subject: English

General Instructions

- The assignment must be done on A4-size ruled sheets
- The students MUST maintain neatness and legibility while writing the answers
- All the questions must be attempted in the given serial order
- Attempt all the questions
  - Integrated Grammar Practice
  - Words often confused
  - Synonyms and Antonyms
  - Reading Comprehension

SECTION A- READING SKILLS

I. Read the passage given below.

1. Social media has become almost a necessity for us, in today's world. It has become so important and evolved so much, that we carry our social media with us throughout the day, on our phones.

2. One of the major benefits of social media is that you can connect with people all over the world, for free. This comes in handy if you have friends who have travelled abroad. You can send them messages on Facebook, Twitter, or Instagram, and they can respond quickly from wherever they are. Social media helps to fortify and maintain your relationships, even with people who are far away from you. If you have a family member who is travelling, you will not have to wait until they return to hear about their adventures. Just hop on Facebook or Instagram and start chatting and exchanging pictures.

3. This ability to communicate quickly and easily with people overseas is also very convenient for those who do business, in foreign lands. Social media platforms provide a cheap, easy way to quickly communicate your point to your customers or clients, who are across the world. You can send a private message, publicly share something, or video chat, for free. Using social media for a company is very cost-effective and time-efficient. Staying connected to these people is important to improve your business relationship, and keep your company running properly.

4. Staying connected to your social networks on the platforms that you use can be vital to your professional success. Through social media sites, you can find jobs, inform your community of business opportunities and career openings, and you can even monetize your accounts. Keeping a well-maintained network will help you achieve success in your career. A good site to look at, if you are trying to create a professional network, is LinkedIn. The site is designed specifically to help you advance in your career. You will open plenty of new opportunities that you did not have, before.

5. Being an active participant in social media is a great way to learn new things. News outlets are constantly using social media, to help keep people in the loop. Social media is the way that news is heard, and it is the way that news is spread. You can make the argument that staying connected to social media is, staying connected to life.

6. It is not only good for sharing and spreading the news, it is a great place to find out about people's opinions on various topics. For example, if you have built a sports community, you will learn about the sports that you love. You can build communities around politics, business, cars, family, education, and pretty much whatever other topic you would like. Social media will enhance your life. It will provide you the chance to communicate, connect and be involved like never before. You will stay connected with news outlets, family, friends and virtually whatever else you would like to connect with.

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below.

a. List 1 major benefit of social media.

b. Using social media for a company is:

1. very cost effective.
2. time efficient.
3. very profitable.

i. Only 1 ii. 1 and 2 iii. 1 and 3 iv. 2 and 3

c. Substitute the word 'necessity' with ONE WORD similar in meaning, in the following sentence from paragraph 1:
Social media has become almost a **necessity** for us, in today's world.

d. Which of the following is not a social media platform?
i. Facebook ii. Instagram iii. Google iv. Twitter

e. For whom is the ability to communicate quickly and easily with people overseas very convenient?
i.those who live away from their families
ii.those who have connections with people in other countries
iii.those who travel to foreign lands a lot
iv.those who do business in foreign lands

f. Social media platforms that you use can be vital to your professional success because through them you can:
1. create a business circle and increase your business connections
2. inform your community of business opportunities
3. find jobs
4. monetize your accounts
5. inform your community of career openings
i. 1, 2 and 4 ii. 2, 3 and 4 iii. 1, 2, 3 and 4 iv. 2, 3, 4 and 5

g. State whether the following statement is **TRUE or FALSE:**
LinkedIn is a good site to look at if you are trying to create a professional network.

h. Based on your reading of the text, list any 2 features of social media.

i. Choose ONE WORD from paragraph 6 that clearly states the meaning of the phrase 'further improve the quality or value of something'.

j. Which of the following is an appropriate title for the passage?
i. The Beneficial Social Media
ii. Social Media - A Necessity
iii. Importance of Staying Connected Through Social Media
iv. The Revolution of the Whole World Around the Social Media

2. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

1. Bodie was named after Waterman S. Body (also known as William S. Bodey), who discovered gold here in 1859. The town of Bodie became famous with the decline of mining along the western slope of the Sierra Nevada. Prospectors crossing the eastern slope in 1859 to search for gold, discovered what was to be the Comstock Lode at Virginia City and started a wild rush to the surrounding high desert country.

2. By 1879, Bodie boasted a population of about 10,000 and was second to none for wickedness, bad men, and 'the worst climate out of doors.' One little girl, whose family was taking her to the remote and infamous town, wrote in her diary: "Goodbye God, I'm going to Bodie."

3. You can see the mighty mines and mills on the west slope of Bodie that pumped economic lifeblood into the town. Because the old mill buildings and surrounding area are extremely perilous, they are closed to the public. In the centre and south of town, a pulsating business district thrived, flanked to the west by the well-kept homes of mine management and business owners.

4. Today more than 200,000 people a year visit this genuine California gold-mining ghost town, where more than 170 buildings are protected in a state of 'arrested decay' on more than 1,000 remote acres. Bodie State Historic Park is open year-round. It opens at 8 a.m. every day but closing time changes seasonally. However, because of the high elevation (8,375 feet), it is accessible only by over-snow equipment during the winter months. Many four-wheel drive vehicles get stuck each year in powdery snow that is deeper than it first appears.

5. In the 1940s, the threat of vandalism faced the ghost town. The Cain family, who owned much of the land, hired caretakers to protect and maintain the town's structures. Only a small part of the town survived, with about 110 structures still standing, including one of many once-operational gold mills. Visitors can walk the

abandoned streets of a town that once was a bustling area of activity. Interiors remain as they were left and stocked with goods. Littered throughout the park, one can find small shards of China dishes, square nails, and an occasional bottle, but removing these items is against the rules of the park.

6. Bodie is a rare example of the dry summer, with warm summers and long and snowy winters. Winds can sweep across the valley at close to 100 miles per hour. Nights remain cold even through the summer, often dropping well below freezing throughout the year.

Based on your reading, answer the following questions by choosing the correct option:

1. Bodie had a population of 10,000 in 1879 because _____.
i. it had been discovered recently ii. all their gold was looted away
iii. there were not enough houses iv. people were not secure

2. The old mill buildings are closed to the public _____.
i. as it is a private property ii. as people make it unsafe
iii. as it is unsafe iv. as public can damage it

3. Bodie State Historic Park is accessible only with over-snow equipment _____.
i. as it is winter over there all year ii. it snows heavily there
iii. its timings change seasonally iv. it is not at a great height

4. Any four-wheel drive vehicle gets stuck each year in Bodie Park as _____.
i. the snow is very thin layered ii. snow is deeper than what it appears
iii. strong winds blow there iv. one cannot predict the weather

5. What is the synonym of 'unpredictable'?
i. uncommon ii. unknown iii. given iv. random

6. What threat did the ghost town face in 1940?
i. Complete burn down ii. Deliberate destruction
iii. Robbery and theft iv. Illegal entry

7. What kind of weather conditions does the town of Bodie have?
i. dry-summer ii. long and snowy winters
iii. below freezing throughout the year iv. all of the options

8. Which word in the passage means the same as ‘uninhibited’?
i. vandalism ii. bustling iii. shards iv. abandoned

9. What brought life and business to the town?
i. Mines and mills ii. Search for gold
iii. Bodie State Historic Park iv. Old buildings and surrounding area

10. Which word in Para 3 means the opposite of ‘safe and secure’?
i. pulsating ii. thrived iii. flanked iv. perilous

SECTION B (WRITING AND GRAMMAR)

3. **Your cousin is getting engaged and you have to attend the function at Jodhpur. You are Mohinder, a student of Jain School, Agra. Write a letter to the principal for a leave of five days.**

4. **Fill in the blanks with the correct forms of the verbs given in the bracket.**
   a. He _____ his first championship in 2012. Since then, he _____ everything and _____ only once. (win, win, lose)
   b. When we finally _____ at the camp it _____ heavily. (arrive, rain)
   c. Dad _____ a walk with the dog every afternoon. (take)
   d. I cannot reach my manager. He _____ in North America at the moment. (travel)
   e. I _____ to the meeting yesterday because I _____ about it. (not go, not inform)
   f. I _____ your uncle for ages. I don't know where he _____ right now. (not see, be)
   g. The family usually _____ breakfast together during the week, but on weekends everyone _____ breakfast on their own. (have, have)

h. I _____ this school for the last two years. Before that, I _____ to Jackson High School for a year. (attend, go)
i. What _____ when the headmaster _____ the room yesterday afternoon? (you do, enter)
j. I _____ at the door for ages. Where _____? (knock, you be)
k. He _____ noise for a whole hour before the neighbours finally _____ the police. (make, call)
l. She _____ well yesterday, probably because she _____ too much. (not feel, eat)
m. It was a wonderful morning and the sun _____ brightly when I _____ up. (shine, get)
n. They _____ this church in the 19th century and since then it _____ renovated. (build, never be)
o. The President _____ to Virginia for a campaign speech next Sunday. (go)